

Provider and Specialty Billing Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy governs claim evaluation based on provider specialty, location, and historical risk profile. Different specialties carry different cost benchmarks and denial risk levels. Provider location also influences regional cost expectations.

2. Specialty-Based Rules

Certain specialties such as Cardiology and Orthopedic have higher average procedure costs and stricter billing standards. Claims from these specialties are evaluated against specialty-specific benchmarks rather than general averages.

Rule	Threshold / Condition	Action
Cardiology	High cost threshold applies	Enhanced review
Orthopedic	Procedure-diagnosis match required	Standard review
Neurology	Diagnosis count >= 2 required	Standard review
General	Standard billing thresholds apply	Automated review
Unknown	Specialty not recognised	Manual review required

3. Location-Based Benchmarks

Claims are evaluated against regional cost benchmarks based on provider location (e.g. Mumbai, Delhi, Bangalore, Chennai, Hyderabad). Billing amounts significantly above the regional benchmark for a given specialty and category will be flagged. Location is used as a normalisation factor in cost analysis.

4. Provider Risk Classification

Rule	Threshold / Condition	Action
Low Risk	provider_risk_score < 0.3	Standard processing
Medium Risk	risk_score between 0.3-0.7	Secondary review
High Risk	provider_risk_score > 0.7	Enhanced scrutiny

Critical	provider_risk_score > 0.9	All claims held for audit
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5. Specialty and Diagnosis Consistency

The provider specialty must be consistent with the diagnosis code and claim category. For example, a Cardiology provider billing for a Skin category claim without a supporting cross-specialty referral will be flagged for inconsistency.

6. Compliance Requirements

- Providers must maintain an up-to-date specialty registration in the system.
- Claims from providers with risk_score > 0.7 require supervisor sign-off.
- Location must match the provider's registered practice address.
- Specialty-diagnosis mismatches must be resolved before claim processing.
- Providers with risk_score > 0.9 are subject to full claim hold pending review.